ENTREPRENEUR GUIDE TO CAREERS

Achieve your version of professional success in a way that excites you

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Academic and Professional Development Matters for Entrepreneurs

Entrepreneurs are spontaneous and fun-loving, always on the lookout for adventure and excitement. As a result, it would be easy to assume that they aren't particularly ambitious or concerned about achievement – but that isn't at all the case. Entrepreneurs care very much about being successful, and they have their own individual visions of what that means. One Entrepreneur might be striving for a prestigious dream job while another might want to build the financial freedom to take off a year and travel the globe.

While Entrepreneurs have many gifts – including their willingness to leap in and act – they, like everyone, face obstacles on the path to success. During their school years, people with this personality type may find themselves bored by standard curricula and teaching methods. If they lose motivation as a result, they may not attain the level of academic achievement that they'd hope for – which can shake their confidence. In the workforce, Entrepreneurs may likewise find it challenging to make steady progress and stay on task in the absence of exciting new developments.

The good news? When Entrepreneurs find academic or career pursuits that excite them – whether it's world history or wilderness first aid – they unleash their energy and passion, growing into their full potential. And Entrepreneurs can use their adventurous energy to infuse a dose of excitement into even subjects and tasks that don't seem particularly fun.

In these pages, we'll discuss how Entrepreneurs can bring the full force of their strengths to their academic and professional pursuits – and how they can stay motivated and make progress toward their longer-term goals. Along the way, we'll cover how Entrepreneurs can overcome challenges that people with their personality type often experience, including how to collaborate with people who don't see eye to eye with them and how to plan for the future without losing their spontaneous edge. When they harness their talents and work through their weaknesses, Entrepreneurs often find that their observational skills, passionate energy, and quick thinking are exactly what they need to achieve their version of success.

Curious about the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them? You can learn more here.

Academic Path

Entrepreneurs are naturally curious individuals with a passion for learning new skills, especially those with practical benefits. True to their name, they see education as an opportunity to gain information and proficiency they can then apply to their interests. Rock climbing enthusiasts, for example, may pursue degrees in geology to learn more about the formations they're coming in close contact with.

Whatever paths they take in their lives, Entrepreneurs benefit from embracing education and looking for learning opportunities. Whether they're learning about medieval history in the classroom or teaching themselves how to build websites in their own home, Entrepreneurs can benefit from expanding their minds and increasing their skills.

In these paragraphs, we'll discuss how Entrepreneurs learn best throughout their academic career, what struggles they may face in educational environments, and how they can improve their learning habits.

How Entrepreneurs Learn

Balanced Learning Habits

Hands-On and Spontaneous Experiences

Learning opportunities that involve hands-on mastery and allow for spontaneous learning experiences interest Entrepreneurs. They learn best in unstructured environments with loosely structured curricula with an emphasis on the experiential. Entrepreneurs react positively to personal involvement in their learning, especially if they're focused on mastering the topic.

While they're usually restless in a lecture hall setting, if they discover a niche – like athletics or mechanics – they're likely to respond well. Entrepreneurs dislike just sitting still and absorbing information. But give them something practical to do, and they become engaged. Allow them to express themselves in an interesting and amusing fashion, and they shine. Ask them to recite a historical timeline, and they're instantly not interested.

Entrepreneurs, at their best, enjoy coaching and feedback on their performance. While nobody likes criticism, these students are serious about mastering what interests them and appreciate any honest observations that can help them do that. The optimal learning style for Entrepreneurs is modeling: they like to watch a technique performed, immediately perform the same technique themselves, and then receive feedback on their performance. Once they gain confidence in their mastery, they're likely to put their own spin on their work.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

Loathing Traditional Structure

Entrepreneurs can struggle in an overly-structured, traditional classroom setting. Unfortunately, most academic settings focus on providing structure for students, approaching education as if everyone learns in the same way. Since most of the population is made up of Sentinel personality types, the idea that structured curriculum works best is consistently reinforced.

This system doesn't work well for Explorer types such as Entrepreneurs, who are, ostensibly, anti-Sentinels. This doesn't mean they don't like Sentinels or are against them. Rather, they work in an almost opposite manner. Sentinels are rules-based and prefer upholding tradition. They're orderly and think in linear ways, and traditional classrooms cater to their love of the predictable and routine. Entrepreneurs, however, tend to struggle in such restrictive environments.

Unfortunately for Entrepreneurs, Sentinels dominate our society and set the standards for what is generally accepted as good pedagogy in

most educational systems. Many teachers and school administrators are also Sentinels. Generally, this sort of stability through standards-setting is an essential service Sentinels offer society. However, it can present real challenges for Entrepreneurs.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Seeking Opportunities for Spontaneity

Parents and instructors who want to reach Entrepreneurs and engage them in the learning process must help them find their niche and provide them with opportunities to be spontaneous. Giving these students something to do on their own provides some much-needed freedom to express themselves. Always looking for something new and novel, they tend to respond to instruction that has a feeling of boldness and spontaneity to it. Entrepreneurs like to reach decisions or conclusions in their own time based on what they discover. However, once they make such discoveries, they may not wait around for others before they implement them. Instructors should include enough flexibility in their lesson plans to accommodate this.

Still, it's important to remember that Entrepreneurs are likely to only take so much spoon-feeding before they go off on their own. Parents and instructors must allow them plenty of time to work on projects on their own schedules and in their own ways.

However, it's also worth pointing out that Entrepreneurs also enjoy working with others and need a wide range of activities rich in personal involvement. Too much seclusion or time spent working on assignments alone can cause impatience and boredom. Group activities are more stimulating for this personality type, especially those that model the skills they're learning. Working with a group dissecting frogs for biology provides much more significant learning outcomes for this type than labeling the frog's anatomy on a worksheet or writing a report about a frog's major organs.

Entrepreneurs in High School

If you've been to high school, you don't have to watch even one of the thousands of films about teenage angst to know that there's more to it than just classes. Most would agree there are as many lessons in schoolyards and hallways as there are in classrooms. So, let's take a moment to consider high school as a place where some critical social lessons unfold.

Balanced Entrepreneurs in High School

Energetic and Sociable

Entrepreneurs in high school can use their considerable charm and sociability to ensure they're never without a group of friends or dates to the prom. They're fun, energetic, and always looking for novel experiences. They love drama and excitement. They're aware of – and excited about – the world around them and appreciate it for what it is. Entrepreneurs in high school tend to be invited to the best parties and are likely to go to them just to see what's new.

Regarding a balanced approach to learning, Entrepreneurs understand the necessity of attending classes and getting passing grades. They may struggle with the class structure but are likely to excel at anything that allows them to use their creativity to pursue unique ideas or to practice their leadership skills in group activities. Hands-on activities, from building a birdhouse in shop class to participating in a model United Nations project, lead to greater interest and increased learning for these perceptive and practical students.

Extracurricular activities often pigeonhole modern teens into stereotypical niches: Cheerleaders are the popular kids, Latin Club is for the nerds, and so on. Entrepreneurs are usually athletic and, if involved in extracurricular activities, probably gravitate toward football or basketball. They tend to get to know people through shared activities rather than sitting down and talking with them. If Entrepreneur students are involved with clubs or groups to enhance their social lives, they prefer them to be something both active and productive.

Unbalanced Entrepreneurs in High School

Out of Sync with the System

If they take an unbalanced approach to education, Entrepreneurs often have a difficult time in high school. As discussed above, typical classrooms aren't a great fit for them. Their learning preferences may be so at odds with what happens in the average classroom they can come across as troublemakers or as not being bright. Within the system, it's easy to miss a genius of another type lurking below the surface in such students. Unfortunately, too many teachers and parents lack this perspective, and they often view Entrepreneurs as uncooperative or incapable.

Let the other students memorize cold, hard facts or play with ideas – but make sure Entrepreneurs have something practical to do. In high school, point Entrepreneur students toward anything social, athletic, or any hands-on skills that need mastery. If left to struggle within traditional education, Entrepreneurs aren't only likely to suffer poor grades, but the emotional and psychological distress can also be painful for them. The constant message they receive from their school environment is too often that they're out of sync with everyone else. While popular among their peers, there may still be a sense they don't fit in that can cause a great deal of damage to their self-esteem.

Rebalancing Entrepreneurs in High School

Relating Learning to Personal Interests

Entrepreneurs enjoy a wide range of interests. When they find activities they can connect with, they're likely to not only put in a great deal of effort to master them, but also tolerate the passive lecture halls a little better, too. Entrepreneurs settle down and apply themselves more in school when they find their niche – or, in effect, find themselves.

When they're allowed to express themselves in ways true to their nature, they can sometimes find more patience for subjects that don't fit their interests. With a sense of fulfillment, it won't feel like they must deny themselves to do so. Once Entrepreneurs feel able to commit to something, they're passionate and loyal people, and that can spread to other less exciting parts of their lives – like the traditional classroom.

Work or College?

While many reasons are involved in deciding whether to go to college other than personality types, they can have a role in the equation. Most people over the years thought of attending college or university as the quickest path to success and security. Now some of these same people are vigorously arguing against higher education for everyone, having seen college dropouts succeed on a grand scale in our technological age – Steve Jobs and Bill Gates being the two most famous examples.

There's a niche for everyone and college is just one possible path to finding it. However, individuals who don't obtain college degrees may struggle to find work and aren't as likely to generate the same income as those who obtain those magical slips of paper. So, what might Entrepreneurs consider when deciding between attending university or going to work?

It's easy to see action-conscious Entrepreneurs wanting to get out into the world quickly to perform and produce. However, their need to master their craft can be just as insistent as their need to perform. They're the two things Entrepreneurs must weigh and balance when thinking about college. If they have an image of it as a place with a lot of lecture halls and books, it may not appeal to them.

However, if they see it as a place with a vibrant social life, studios, workshops, and practice rooms, these may attract them to higher education. Balance can be attained just by choosing the right major at the right college. These types could find apprenticeships in the nonacademic world, but college provides "ready-made" opportunities to learn from others. (Occasionally, Entrepreneurs go into occupations that need certification. In those cases, they have no other choice than pursuing higher education.)

Entrepreneurs in College

Balanced Entrepreneurs in College

Free to Find Their Way

Those Entrepreneurs who choose to go to a college or university most likely feel set free. No longer bound by the rules of high school life, these students may finally find educational models that fit their style of learning. For many Entrepreneurs, leaving home and high school for college tends to be a liberating experience.

Entrepreneurs' course choices tend to be like the subjects they connected with in high school. Athletic or engineering-type disciplines in all their forms are a primary interest for many Entrepreneur college students, as well as some other active professions. Entrepreneurs should cautiously avoid pressure to choose majors and courses that present the same difficulties they faced in high school. Sometimes parents and guidance counselors, with all the best intentions, can send high school graduates in the wrong direction in college. If Entrepreneurs didn't embrace more abstract, theoretical coursework in high school, the chances aren't any better for doing so when they go to college.

Unbalanced Entrepreneurs in College

Too Focused on Enjoying the Moment

Some feel that college and university are only about getting the tools necessary to make a good living. Most Entrepreneurs reject this as the primary reason to get a degree. Mastery and creativity tend to be the primary motivation for typical Entrepreneurs. Rightly or wrongly, they usually believe their passion can see them through. Not being too risk-averse, Entrepreneurs emphasize picking up skills in the "here and now" with only slight regard for the future.

Do Entrepreneurs look for "party schools" to strengthen their university experiences? Like most young people, they'll delight in the autonomy that going away to college offers. For many students, this is the first significant taste of life apart from their families and their families' rules. Some even choose their universities based on their distance from home.

It's no different for Entrepreneurs who are just as interested in coming into their own. They tend to fit nicely into campus party life. Their thirst for novelty and outgoing nature may lead them from party to party, with little downtime in between. They must be careful not to allow their social lives to overshadow any other reasons they may be attending college. This is an area in which Entrepreneurs must exercise caution.

Rebalancing Entrepreneurs in College

Learning to Deal with Difficulty

College is a time for Entrepreneurs to consider and exploit their strengths and talents in real ways. They can customize their courses of study to enough of a degree that they can feel fulfilled. However, everyone must take those courses most of us don't want to – the foundational, prerequisite courses. Entrepreneurs may want to embrace the idea that into every life a little mundane must fall. While there's often an option to "test out" of these courses, there are tremendous benefits to participating in these classes – and a little tolerance toward them may render some surprising material that proves more interesting than imagined.

Learning to cope with dull or overly challenging courses is good disciplinary practice for Entrepreneurs. This isn't the only time that they'll run into necessary tasks that feel meaningless and boring to them. College can help Entrepreneurs gain tolerance for such things and prepare them to approach the adult world in more balanced and realistic ways.

Conclusion

In aiming toward the ambitious creativity that even the name "Entrepreneurs" suggests, this type almost naturally embraces the role of lifelong learner. The initial trick in promoting learning for them won't involve directly motivating them or pushing them to improve skills, hoping their interest will ignite after the fact. The trick is to help them find an interactive discipline that grabs and inspires them up front. On discovering an interest, Entrepreneurs are likely to throw themselves into the process. Typically, when they find their niche, they look for ways to increase their skill levels on their own. With that focus in place, they may even find education, in a broader sense, more appealing.

Entrepreneurs can help themselves get ahead in education by understanding how learning and training work for them. Nurturing and indulging their tendency toward curiosity can be beneficial as they search for their passions. Exploring with a purposeful emphasis on discovery can help start them on their educational – and perhaps professional – paths.

Professional Development

Entrepreneurs' primary challenge is finding careers that are in line with their style and independent nature. While there's no one line of work that's best suited to them, it may be essential to find jobs that fit their unique temperament.

This section explores how Entrepreneurs can use their traits to maintain balance and excel in their professions. We'll look at what frustrates them and throws them off-balance at work – as well as strategies to repair unbalanced situations. Ultimately, the goal of this chapter is to provide tools to help Entrepreneurs succeed in the workplace.

Entrepreneurs do best when they remember to listen to themselves, especially when deciding on a choice of career. This advice may come easily to most of them. They know what they want and don't let social pressure force them into positions that are bad fits for their unique personality type.

This advice doesn't mean they should avoid entry-level positions, which may start as unsatisfying or uninteresting initially. When all is said and done, it's Entrepreneurs' responsibility to find jobs that allow them to feel happy in their professional environments. They need enough room to breathe – and such space is unlikely in incompatible fields where they must struggle to get a foothold using someone else's methods.

Hands-On, "In the Moment" Workers

Entrepreneurs live in the moment. They look for the results of their actions immediately instead of thinking about or projecting things into

the future. This style makes them "hands-on" workers, whether literally or just in the sense they involve themselves in their tasks from start to finish.

People with this personality type are less interested in building extensive systems or planning for contingency scenarios. They're happy to leave that to more technically-oriented Analysts. Instead, Entrepreneurs fare well where they must do unfamiliar work under time constraints.

Social – and Sociable – Employees

Entrepreneurs are charming, popular individuals with excellent networking skills – social characteristics they can apply to any work. Their calmness in stressful situations can be comforting to clients, coworkers, and supervisors; however, they aren't too interested in diplomacy or empathy. They may bypass such things if they believe doing so can still bring the results they desire. While these Extraverts clearly connect with others, there is likely to be a sense that doing so is more of an important option than an absolute necessity. This can make them powerful negotiators.

Practical and Persuasive

Entrepreneurs do best when they embrace front line roles, such as selling cars or running businesses. Their intrinsic desire to persuade others is likely to be a priority for them in their workplace. While they would rather deal with practical matters over the more theoretical, it wouldn't be unusual for Entrepreneurs to do the unexpected – perhaps becoming politicians despite having little curiosity about political theory. Their energy and charisma are likely to help them succeed in such career paths.

Entrepreneurs are likely to be down-to-earth individuals, which helps them to remain calm when situations become difficult. These types don't care about superfluous information when it comes to making actual decisions. They focus on reality rather than theories and abstract concepts. Consequently, they tend to succeed in careers that reward practicality and efficiency – and, most importantly, focus on concrete, factual data.

Risk Takers

It's hard to imagine Entrepreneurs choosing a secure, boring job over a less stable but more exciting career path. People with this personality type are decisive and able to keep a cool head in critical situations. They feel comfortable making decisions on the go and take risks where others would falter – and usually come out as winners. In the right place and at the right time, taking effective chances can help push Entrepreneurs up career ladders (if they're climbing them), and can contribute to their being brilliant entrepreneurs (note the small "e") and freelancers. Their boldness and improvisation skills can be formidable advantages in competitive environments.

Entrepreneurs aren't interested in the stability and security that are so dear to Sentinels. Instead, they live and breathe adrenaline, seeking excitement and novelty, and pushing limits further and further. Entrepreneurs are unmatched when it comes to exploring the unknown and in reaching the heights of human ability. It drives and motivates them, and this is what they should be focusing on – positioning themselves in ways that allow them to concentrate on using their improvisation and problem-solving skills. They also must retain enough freedom to choose their methods.

Hidden Leaders

Their more free-form, risk-taking style can make it hard to see the leadership qualities Entrepreneurs possess. They may not appear disciplined enough. However, as hardened front-line soldiers, Entrepreneurs acquire an excellent ability to lead, even if such skills lurk beneath the surface. This quality can supercharge their careers if these potential leaders are in the right place at the right time.

People with this personality type should always keep their eyes open if the organizations they work for are prone to experiencing unexpected turbulence occasionally. There may be leadership opportunities close at hand.

Impatience

Entrepreneurs can be impatient, so careers or roles involving meticulous research or repetitive tasks aren't likely to be a good fit for them.

Unfortunately, there are very few jobs where periods of slow, detailed work aren't occasionally part of the work week.

Entrepreneurs can rely too much on the practical and that which is happening in the moment. They may not always spend enough time expanding their knowledge or developing solid plans if they don't see current uses. They may disregard anything that doesn't provide them with immediate benefits or coax them to take immediate action.

Low Tolerance for Structure

Entrepreneurs dislike restrictive rules and highly structured environments. They prefer to trust their abilities and ideas instead of waiting for someone "at the top" to tell them what to do. This sometimes lands these types in trouble if unchecked. Their need for independence may challenge the established hierarchy, and some managers may not approve of their renegade ways. Ideally, Entrepreneurs would do well in careers where there's little structure and a great deal of room for independent expression.

Career Options for Entrepreneurs

Balanced Career Options

Below is an offering of jobs consistent with Entrepreneurs' traits. It's by no means comprehensive – that would be impossible, and the list would grow daily. Hopefully, the descriptions below can serve as guidelines for Entrepreneurs just beginning to explore potential careers.

For those already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or explanation of why they might be happy or unhappy where they are. This offering doesn't presume to be a firm prescription of what they

must do to be successful or happy. Rather, it's intended just to provide insights and broad guidelines.

Business and Sales

Entrepreneurs hold many qualities that make business careers a perfect fit for them. They're practical and not afraid to take risks. They're friendly, smooth, and persuasive. They have a natural flair for storytelling, and "branding" comes easily to them because of this skill. Entrepreneurs also tend to be powerful networkers, a skill useful in building businesses. People with this personality type seek the new and the innovative, and this puts them on the cutting edge – a potent characteristic to have in competitive business fields.

If there's a "glitch" discovered there's no better personality type to fix it. In fact, Entrepreneurs occasionally put problem-solving over the feelings and concerns of others. This can do damage to a team, but they get the job done, and bosses often overlook their occasional renegade ways – especially if they do away with troubling problems.

This ability to make trouble disappear is usually the reason Entrepreneurs climb corporate ladders fairly quickly. The dues they pay aren't about faithful compliance as much as about solving spectacular problems. This skill is how they get noticed.

Some possible business positions for Entrepreneurs include:

- Business management and administration
- Insurance sales
- Investment banking
- Entrepreneur
- Money management
- Real estate
- Non-profit fundraising
- Sales of any kind
- Advertising and public relations
- Event management

High-Octane, Active Jobs

When it comes to careers, Entrepreneurs have a long and diverse list of jobs from which to choose. They're quick decision-makers who are excellent candidates for roles that require thinking on their feet, such as sales, emergency services, crisis management, military, police, and anything of that nature.

Entrepreneurs are all about getting the job done and rarely let emotional distractions get in the way. This is useful during catastrophic crises that need cool heads. First responder jobs also provide them with new, exceptional experiences. Novelty energizes them, and emergency work provides an opportunity to master unique problems in real time. Since nothing is boring or mundane about helping somebody in real physical danger, such opportunities clearly speak to Entrepreneurs.

Their energetic natures push them toward action-oriented positions rather than highly analytical roles. People with this personality type are often excellent athletes. They're competitive, energetic, and are thrilled by action – pursuing careers as athletes or sportscasters may be right up their alley.

- Ambulance medic (EMT)
- Emergency room physician or nurse
- Police
- Firefighter
- Military
- Correction officer
- Investigator
- Disaster management
- Athlete
- Sportscaster

Law and Politics

Both law and politics involve a certain amount of putting out metaphorical fires. Entrepreneurs tend to be comfortable facing down opponents in courtrooms or political debates. They energetically apply themselves to solving legal or government problems and find fulfillment in creating satisfactory solutions for their clients or their constituents.

Charming, popular, and being great storytellers are advantages for lawyers and politicians, and Entrepreneurs are often equipped with all three characteristics. While politicians are supposed to have vision, Entrepreneur politicians are more likely to have solutions. They're likely to be more "bread and butter" candidates than those who profess to lead others to some ideological Promised Land.

Unbalanced Career Options

In modern society, individuals not only spend a great deal of time at work, but they also tend to allow their careers to give their lives meaning. Entrepreneurs must be careful not to get stuck in situations that don't suit them, or they may risk all manner of difficulties in the workplace.

Working Alone

Entrepreneurs won't be comfortable in cubicles doing solitary work unless it involves phone sales or other outreach. But even then, they'll yearn for more solid human interaction. Being stuck in cubicles working with a lot of lifeless data or paperwork is downright deadly to Entrepreneurs. They need people and often like to be the person in the front of the room.

Mundane and Repetitive

Entrepreneurs are most comfortable with activities that involve novelty and spontaneity. Repetitive work of any kind tends to fall short for them. They're great improvisers and easily get bored without challenges related to their skill sets.

Restrictive Environments

Entrepreneurs like to experiment and explore new ideas. If the structure and rules of their workplace are too rigid, they'll more than likely feel stifled and unfulfilled. These problem-solvers and innovators aren't happy when they can't exercise those passions. People with this personality type also like to take risks which may be frowned upon in offices that strongly emphasize rules.

Alternative Options

Self-Employment

Many people find the notion of self-employment scary. However, the days when someone would spend twenty years or more working for the same company are over. Job security and guaranteed prospects are a thing of the past, except in specialized fields such as the military or medicine. Working for oneself may be a more secure and viable option, which also comes with a range of other benefits such as the ability to plan one's time, seeing the tangible results of one's work, and obviously being one's own boss. Entrepreneurs value freedom and self-reliance and being self-employed gives them excellent opportunities to enjoy these things.

Self-employment also side-steps one of the major hurdles that Entrepreneurs are likely to encounter in the corporate environment – forced compliance with numerous rules. While nobody is ever completely free from obligatory tasks, as self-employed individuals, Entrepreneurs have more flexibility to choose which tasks they want to perform and which they want to delegate or outsource.

This self-determination can relieve them of performing some mundane administrative work or having to follow others' irrational, unnecessary orders. Self-employment offers many major benefits to Entrepreneurs, especially in today's global and constantly connected environment. People with this personality are likely to succeed as their own bosses.

Entrepreneurship

Entrepreneurs may feel comfortable with a career that shares their name. Their willingness to take risks shines when they explore building their own enterprises. Plenty of "entrepreneurs" (small "e") give up after trying and failing because they were too afraid to jump into a pool full of what they see as sharks. Entrepreneurs (capital "E") are comfortable with risk and trust in their ability to find practical solutions quickly. They're likely to take risks, see what happens, and then deal with the consequences. They know what it means to be entrepreneurs because they've been trying new and dicey things all their lives.

However, without the right idea, a business goes nowhere. Entrepreneurs wishing to open the doors of their own businesses must think of interesting ways to fulfill existing needs (or create them) and do it better than their competitors. This wouldn't be difficult for them, given their amazing ability to improvise. Give Entrepreneurs strong ideas from the start, and they'll likely manage the rest easily.

Climbing the Career Ladder

Entrepreneurs tend to be very adaptable. Even at school – which is a source of frustration for many of them – they're likely to improvise and experiment in ways that perplex other types. They typically make decisions on the spot and refuse to plan or prepare for contingencies. However, Entrepreneurs are unstoppable when they find niches that give them the freedom to choose their preferred courses of action or to manage and influence other people. However, getting such opportunities may be challenging.

Making Contact

Entrepreneurs are likely to have no problem when it comes to socializing and networking. Their social natures can enhance any job hunting efforts, especially in tough job markets where their energy and outgoing natures can distinguish them from the herd. These individuals are likely to possess a keen eye for detail, a solid grasp on reality, and the gift of persuasiveness – skills that can help them get their foot in the door.

Relating Outside Interests

People with this type are likely to have plenty of outside activities to highlight on their resumes or during interviews. Entrepreneurs' hands-on nature doesn't just appear overnight. Whether it's hobbies or sports, they probably have plenty of examples of their skills and energy to draw on.

Some relevant activities that Entrepreneurs entering the job market can use to enhance their applications include volunteer work, competitions, local neighborhood initiatives, small businesses, or a Web presence such as a blog or a social media presence.

Also, the more activities in Entrepreneurs' history, the more likely they can use them to provide breathing space during interviews. Answering a question like, "Describe a situation where you used your problem-solving skills," is much easier if there are plenty of real-life experiences to choose from for the answer.

Preparing for the Interview

Entrepreneurs may find it easy to show their prospective employers that they're very dedicated, capable, and trustworthy. However, before interviews, these types may want to make sure they've covered all the bases and planned things to highlight during the conversation. The danger in their tendency to "wing it" may be in not presenting a comprehensive enough picture of what they have to offer. They need to present their skills in the right way to distinguish themselves from other candidates. While it may not be their first impulse, taking the time to plan can be truly beneficial.

Entrepreneurs may rely too heavily on their social skills and enthusiasm to put them ahead of the other applicants. In addition to stressing their experience, it never hurts to prepare for common interview techniques and questions so as not to be caught off guard. In fact, some interviewers find it easier to go through a litany of typical questions, such as, "What would you say is one of your weaknesses?" Entrepreneurs tend to be very good candidates in certain fields, but if they fail to prepare and don't get their message across, they risk losing out to less-qualified but better-prepared candidates. It's better to overprepare than underprepare.

Workplace Cooperation Between Types

It's useful to have something in common when speaking with someone else. It can make the rest of the conversation more productive if you start with a resounding "yes" rather than a stubborn "no." This section discusses possible pairings of Role groups, including brief overviews of potential synergies and obstacles, and some tips that may help Entrepreneurs navigate these tricky waters.

Entrepreneur–Analyst Cooperation

Entrepreneurs and Analysts both like to search for answers but their style and scope of doing so are different. However, if they both recognize that they're looking for "better and more efficient ways," it can make any discussion more productive. If they can grasp this and work with their different approaches, they may find that their motives are like enough. Bonding by using the things they have in common while learning the value of their differences can go a long way in these business relationships.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Cooperation

Different Paths to the Same Goal

While Analysts want to play with ideas and systems, Entrepreneurs would rather solve problems in a hands-on fashion. While Analysts may not always see their ideas through to the end, it's hard to get Entrepreneurs to wait long enough to check with others before they carry out theirs. Analysts are more deliberative; Entrepreneurs are somewhat rasher. Entrepreneurs work with the "here and now," focusing on the practical, while Analysts work with overarching systems that are

more conceptual than tangible and often extend into the future. To solve real-world problems, there's nobody better than Entrepreneurs. If you want to know how to understand a system, deconstruct it, or build it better on paper, there's nobody like Analysts.

When Entrepreneurs and Analysts work together, they must understand that they're each part of a two-step process. Entrepreneurs can put together the pieces to make the Analysts' models work. Analysts are notoriously weak at implementation, while Entrepreneurs specialize in it. However, Entrepreneurs sometimes don't pay enough attention to the big picture and instead focus specifically on the details. This can put them out of sync with their organizations' overarching visions – and perhaps into some hot water. As long as each type realizes they both have good things to stir into the same pot, Entrepreneurs and Analysts can create powerful working relationships.

Consider *Apollo 13*, the movie and real-life event that brought us the iconic phrase, "Houston; we have a problem." After a mechanical mishap, three US astronauts were in danger of not making it back to Earth alive in their crippled space capsule. In this scenario, Analysts can be compared to Houston's ground control who calculated all the numbers and worked out a trajectory. They created the system to get the astronauts home.

However, the astronauts (the Entrepreneurs in this analogy) were the problem-solvers who did the hands-on work and manipulated the details to swing their capsule around the Moon and bring it home safely. Communication between ground control and the astronauts was vital to the success of the rescue. This analogy loosely demonstrates how different functions and styles can work together to fulfill the same goal – particularly between theorists and craftspeople.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Analyst Cooperation

Diverse Focus

Analysts may become annoyed at Entrepreneurs' focus on details, while Entrepreneurs may feel that Analysts' ideas are too vague and impractical. (It's likely that they're not, but sometimes theory can appear

that way to these types.) It can be tempting for Entrepreneurs to dismiss Analysts as having their heads in the clouds and not understanding the practical side of anything.

On the other hand, Analysts may declare that Entrepreneurs are reckless, have no vision, and think too narrowly about things. When either or both refuse to see the value of the other's style, communication is likely to shut down.

Analysts can be condescending if they don't feel someone can play skillfully in their playground of lofty notions and complex systems. They may wrongly react to Entrepreneurs' focus on detail and simply write them off as uninspired. Meanwhile, Entrepreneurs are just as likely to ignore Analysts' "nonsense" as they move ahead and complete their preferred hands-on solutions. The result can be that both types quit talking to each other, and that's a pitfall these coworkers may wish to avoid.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Analyst Cooperation

Sharing New Perspectives

Analysts become bored with too many minute details, but this doesn't mean they have no use for them. They need not line up detailed facts in the same way Entrepreneurs do. But it's important for Entrepreneurs to understand their Analyst coworkers don't feel a need to dig into the minutia the same way they do. Entrepreneurs may want to ask their Analyst coworkers to give them feedback from their perspective. They may be surprised at how a bigger picture focus can help them define the tasks they're doing by providing a richer and broader perspective. In fact, a new point of view might save them from going off course. Analyst coworkers can be of immense help to them.

Entrepreneurs may want to be careful to avoid dismissing Analysts and their theories too quickly. They should remember that, despite all their lofty ideas, Analysts want the same thing they do – the successful resolution of problems and challenges. Both types are puzzle solvers, but each has a different technique. It may help communication if Entrepreneurs learn to ask their Analyst coworkers more "why" questions.

Entrepreneur–Diplomat Cooperation

Entrepreneurs (with their Observant, Thinking traits) and Diplomats (with their Intuitive, Feeling traits) as coworkers may appear at cross purposes. Entrepreneurs with their practical approach to life and problems and Diplomats with their more idealistic bent seem likely to conflict with one another. However, if, instead of thinking of these traits as opposite, they each see them as complementary, there may be much potential for Entrepreneur–Diplomat cooperation.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Diplomat Cooperation

The common ground between Diplomats and Entrepreneurs is somewhat intangible, but they share similar attitudes. Both enjoy a sense of moving forward and watching something become better. For Entrepreneurs, it's finding novel and interesting solutions to specific problems. They can look at a situation's tangled mess and figure out how to make it work, often in unique and interesting ways. For Diplomats, it's more about personal growth, moral development, and well-being. They love to flip a fixed idea and create a new perspective that contributes to humanistic improvement.

Despite their differences, both types share respect for flexibility; rules and traditions don't bind either too tightly. While Entrepreneurs tend to be much more practical and utilitarian when compared to Diplomats' idealistic pursuit of values, it's not hard to imagine both types sharing a common appreciation for innovation and change.

Combining Vision with Craft

If Intuitive types and Observant types are open to each other's differences, partnerships between them can offer a lot. Entrepreneurs excel at hands-on activities. They relish the mastery of objects within their physical environment. Diplomats, as Intuitive types, are great at grasping, creating, and transforming ideas. Details bore them, whereas Entrepreneurs are fascinated by them. Entrepreneurs want to know how they can manipulate each little piece and use it to create something new and better – especially if it meets a concrete need or feels like solving a puzzle.

If you want "visions," call on Diplomats. If you want Diplomats' visions realized in down-to-earth but innovative ways, call on Entrepreneurs.

As an illustration, suppose Diplomat coworkers realize that their organization's problem revolves around a need to create a greater sense of community and camaraderie. Communication is poor, and Diplomats sense a lack of connection among their clients and coworkers. Entrepreneur colleagues might answer that realization by creating an email newsletter, a phone chain, a podcast, monthly coffees, or many practical methods for pulling all groups together. They could create a brand around the organization that says "community" and, in doing so, also create a team effort between the Diplomats and Entrepreneurs. While Entrepreneurs continue to contribute the mechanisms, Diplomats can constantly evaluate their progress – and the mood of the stakeholders.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Diplomat Cooperation

A False Dichotomy

While established standards don't bind either Entrepreneurs or Diplomats as tightly as they might Sentinels, Diplomats do have unique codes by which they live. Their values, usually connected to their sense of empathy and compassion, are strong forces in their lives. While Entrepreneurs aren't amoral as a rule, values aren't always as prominent in the way they handle business.

For instance, Entrepreneurs like people and are often friendly, outgoing, and fun. However, occasionally, they may see solving a problem as more important than taking care of their colleagues' or clients' feelings or welfare. They may take risks, cut corners, or cavalierly develop plans that might have a negative impact on others. They may trust their instincts a little too much, doing something on their own without taking other people's opinions or standards into account. Such occasions can create conflicts between Entrepreneurs and Diplomats.

The Doer and the Dreamer

Diplomats may see their Entrepreneur coworkers as shallow, while Entrepreneurs may regard Diplomats as impractical dreamers. Entrepreneurs tend to live in the "here and now," while Diplomats live in the infinite time of imagination and thought. They're more likely concerned with long-range results, while Entrepreneurs are more interested in immediate actions and solutions.

Let's use a hospital metaphor here. Diplomats would be case managers equipped to handle patients' long-term well-being and creating holistic treatment plans for them. Meanwhile, Entrepreneurs are down in the emergency room doing triage and reattaching limbs in their practical way. These two views can create difficulty in communication between them. However, someone running a hospital wants both around if they're going to save lives in the long- and short-term.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Diplomat Cooperation

Discovering Motivations

If Entrepreneurs want to discover what motivates Diplomats, they should first try to find out their values. These coworkers are likely to extend their standards and ideals into their work lives as much as they reasonably can. The best way to communicate with them is to avoid bogging them down with many details or methods. These things are likely to be of little interest to Diplomats, who prefer talking about broader ideas. Entrepreneurs who want to find common ground with Diplomats may want to explore questions that start with "what if." (In return, Diplomats may want to ask questions that begin with "how.")

As with all pairings of distinct types, Entrepreneurs and Diplomats work together best when they learn to appreciate their differences. There's an economy among types which suggests that learning how to relate to different Roles in complementary fashion is likely to bring forth the most effective results.

For Entrepreneurs, this may mean allowing Diplomats to share their values and humanistic insights to give them a larger perspective. Entrepreneurs who accept such perspectives find their work takes on more value and is a lot more accessible to those they impact, such as supervisors and clients.

Entrepreneur–Sentinel Cooperation

It's easy to get the impression that Sentinels and Entrepreneurs are opposites since they often approach things differently. But they aren't without some commonalities. They both prefer to gather information directly from the world around them instead of filtering it through internal mechanisms – neither has much interest in theories.

While Entrepreneurs are more in touch with things directly and immediately, Sentinels usually judge their experiences by remembering how things have always been. They're generally sticklers for rules and structures that support a traditional perspective. Entrepreneurs relish the new and exciting, while Sentinels favor the stable.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Cooperation

To the Rescue

Entrepreneurs and Sentinels most often complement each other when

things go wrong. Sometimes even the tried-and-true ways of doing things fail. This can be disconcerting to predictability-loving Sentinels, but a compelling situation for Entrepreneurs. In this ever-changing world, there are times when old methods no longer work. There may be no other choice but to develop new ways of doing things and there's no type better equipped to help when innovative things need to be done quickly than Entrepreneurs.

Known Places

Sometimes Entrepreneurs' impulsive drive to find solutions can get off track. Sometimes the best answer, when a situation goes bad, is to retreat to a known starting point. "Known places" are where Sentinels like to spend their time.

There are instances when boldly "winging it" can lead to effective solutions. However, there are also times when such approaches create more problems than they solve. Sometimes Sentinels can help Entrepreneurs "come home," figuratively speaking. Sentinels usually know how to repair situations, or they know someone who does. This can be of great help to Entrepreneurs who wander too far off in the wrong direction.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Sentinel Cooperation

Clashing Styles

There are things about Entrepreneurs that drive Sentinels crazy, and the other way around. However, Entrepreneurs have the advantage of usually going with the flow and not allowing others to bother them very much. For Sentinels, however, their problem with Entrepreneurs can be disturbing.

While Entrepreneurs have no problem cutting corners when necessary, Sentinels usually dedicate their lives to making sure those corners remain intact, just the way they've always been. Sentinels like things to be orderly and predictable. Entrepreneurs have a freer attitude and love things that are new and interesting.

Sentinels might prefer favorite restaurants they go to most of the time, and Entrepreneurs are likely to sample all the latest restaurants as they open. At work, Entrepreneurs can come across as reckless and undisciplined. To them, Sentinels might appear boring and uninspired. While their opinions of each other are usually more reactionary stereotypes than accurate assessments, such impressions can hinder trust and open communication.

Varying Regard for the Status Quo

While keeping the status quo strongly in place seems essential to Sentinels, Entrepreneurs have no problem doing what they feel is necessary to solve problems, regardless of "how it's always been done." Sentinels see tried-and-true means as the way to guarantee a predictable end. Only a successful end concerns Entrepreneurs, and they may use any means necessary to get there.

It's easy to see how Sentinels can view Entrepreneurs as being at cross purposes with them. Sentinels may devote an undue amount of time trying to get Entrepreneurs to walk a straight line according to the rules. Meanwhile, Entrepreneurs may ignore Sentinel coworkers as they do whatever they feel they must, including going in a straight line, serpentine, or any other direction that helps them master a situation. The possibilities for conflicts between these colleagues are nearly endless.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Sentinel Cooperation

The Value of Protocols

As the Spanish philosopher and essayist Santayana wrote, "Those who cannot remember the past are condemned to repeat it." Entrepreneurs can be too quick to dismiss Sentinels' inherent attachment to the past and settled protocols. There can be much to learn from their adherence to tradition and set standards. But Entrepreneurs shouldn't be afraid to ask why they must do something a certain way. Sentinels may want to avoid justifying acts or decisions by saying anything that resembles, "Because we've always done it that way."

Mutual Learning

Accepting Sentinels' counsel may help avoid problems. Entrepreneurs may feel Sentinels somehow limit their options. It may even be true. However, it's unlikely that Entrepreneurs can permanently lose their spontaneity and edgy creativity if they play by the rules on occasion. In fact, relying on their Sentinel coworkers' sensitivities to rules and standards may help them stay around to create another day. (When this happens, although Sentinels may never ask for it, they're always happy when someone shows appreciation. Doing so may be a way to create stronger work relationships between Entrepreneurs and Sentinels.)

Entrepreneur–Explorer Cooperation

Obviously, Entrepreneurs and other Explorers typically find themselves "speaking the same language." Theoretical and conceptual problems, which tend to thrill Analysts, are just annoying to both. They find no purpose in going there. Conversations about solving problems or mastering a skill or situation are of great interest. They gain energy and motivation from topics that reveal how they overcame problems and saved the day.

Balanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Cooperation

Whatever Gets the Job Done

Whatever gets the job done is what interests Entrepreneurs and other Explorers who work together. They may bypass rules, standards, or traditions that hinder their focus and strategies. Because of this – and their pronounced spontaneity and independence – others often see them as risk takers.

Entrepreneurs are likely to be comfortable with other Explorers who also seek to do things their way. They like talking about the new and different if these discussions focus on tangible matters and don't wander into the arena of abstract theories. While people belonging to these types might appreciate discussing the capabilities of the new iPhone, they tend to show less interest in discourse about "the future sociological impact of constant digital communications worldwide."

They might share a sense of satisfaction if they figure out a unique use for the phone. The second topic, however, would be "just talk" to these action-oriented coworkers.

Practical Innovation

Entrepreneurs and other Explorers working together in a team are a likely brainstorming powerhouse within their company. They won't only resolve problems but also innovate and add to the growth of their organization – but only as it affects methods. The harnessed energy of Entrepreneurs and Explorers who bounce ideas off each other can be a formidable asset to any employer. Entrepreneur and Explorer coworkers are likely to make any joint discoveries on the run and by applying their hands to problems, rather than drawing out diagrams and steps on a whiteboard.

Unbalanced Entrepreneur–Explorer Cooperation

Problems that arise when Entrepreneurs and other Explorers talk to each other likely have nothing to do with mutual understanding. Instead, they may become stuck in their shared style of thinking without the benefit of insight from those who think differently. In business and life, it's good to have varied personality types around to give balance.

But at What Cost?

On the off-chance that the workplace becomes too "Explorer-heavy," several factors can be problematic. Grace Hopper, the late computer scientist and United States Navy Rear Admiral, famously said, "It's easier to apologize than to get permission." Entrepreneurs and other Explorer types often take this quote to heart, resulting too often in their

getting into trouble. Their willingness to take different paths and risks to find unique solutions can be an asset in the workplace. However, it shouldn't go unchecked.

Like risk-taking, the often-complex relationship Entrepreneurs and other Explorers have with their coworkers may also need tempering. While both types typically enjoy other people, they often put practical solutions ahead of the feelings and concerns of others. They may come across as having a brusque disregard for their coworkers.

It's not that they don't like their colleagues. But they tend to place people below solutions on their list of priorities. "It can't be helped," would be the shared excuse between Entrepreneurs and their Explorer accomplices – if they even discuss such matters – resulting in a gulf between them and other colleagues.

Solutions with a Small Perspective

Entrepreneurs and other Explorers may also find their actions don't align with their organizations' larger visions. Being detail-oriented and thinking in the present, these similar types may disregard the long view of their organization's goals and focus. Just as it takes one degree of a compass to send a ship hundreds of miles off course, so can a small misguided solution potentially disrupt a company's broader goals.

To Entrepreneurs who work with other Explorers, their solutions may seem reasonable. To their supervisors, it can appear as though they're thumbing their noses at the vision and values of their firms. If not adjusted for, the immediacy of the Explorer mindset can create a tunnel vision that ignores greater matters.

Rebalancing Entrepreneur–Explorer Cooperation

Appreciating Commonalities

It's always enjoyable when like minds work together. When Entrepreneurs and other Explorers have the opportunities to do so, they want to enjoy the camaraderie and consider using this time to brainstorm new and better ways of doing things. It's likely these coworkers may enjoy simply spending time talking to each other. The

experience can be kicked up a notch if they find something to tinker with while they're chatting.

Getting a Second Opinion

When two types are so similar and comfortable with each other's great ideas, a second opinion from someone more "mainstream" can be useful. Every personality type can benefit from the balance provided by other types. Even Entrepreneurs and their Explorer teammates can grow as individuals and as teams when they expand their comfort zones by exploring different approaches.

Asking "Why?"

Entrepreneurs and other Explorers who work together may find that they're comfortable exploring the "how" questions involved in finding a solution. To rebalance their efforts to keep their contributions beneficial rather than harmful, learning to ask "why" may be just as essential. This may again require a second opinion from other types more in touch with the bigger picture.

Conclusion

Even from within the teams they so enjoy, Entrepreneurs must exercise independence and expression of their personal skills. Such autonomy is essential to their happiness and motivates them to produce and succeed. If a job feels like it's overstructured and conformity-based, Entrepreneurs won't be able to access that part of themselves that responds to challenges. They need some way to exercise their unique skills.

To thrive in a job, Entrepreneurs must find a niche that is their own. Most are good at this, having practiced it while dealing with school systems focused on more conventional things than they, as young people, could relate to. While not always adept at committing in life in any traditional sense, once they find their niche, they're usually all in for the duration. This allows them to become highly skilled and often specialized – making Entrepreneurs valued workers and professionals in many fields.

Final Words

Movers and Shakers

The world – including schools and workplaces – would be far more boring without Entrepreneurs. Curious and adventurous, people with this personality type are willing to push the boundaries that keep most other people in line, and the results can be nothing short of thrilling.

Of course, school and work aren't always thrilling. Entrepreneurs will inevitably be faced with less-than-fascinating tasks and assignments as well as teachers and colleagues who resist even the merest suggestion of taking risks and doing things differently. For Entrepreneurs to reach their full academic and professional potential, they'll need to learn how to harness their passion and stay motivated even when their to-do list doesn't satisfy their craving for novelty and excitement.

In these pages, we've discussed how Entrepreneurs can draw on their gifts and overcome common obstacles as they go after their academic and professional goals. Our hope is that these insights will help Entrepreneurs to make progress toward their version of success without sacrificing the sense of fun and excitement that they crave in their lives. With their bold improvisational skills and their ability to adapt to whatever the present moment calls for, Entrepreneurs who lean into their strengths and work through their challenges can grow into exactly the movers and shakers that this world so desperately needs.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want more tests and insights to help you excel in your career? Explore our Career Tools and Assessments.
- Looking to enhance your relationships? Check out the *Entrepreneur Guide to Relationships*.
- Ready to build a strong foundation for your self-development? Our *Entrepreneur Guide to Personal Growth* may be just what you need.

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